

The Marketplace Method

Pick the right places to sell your resin pieces, write listings that actually convert, and set shipping and return policies that protect you.

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SECTION 1

Choosing Where to Sell

By the end of this section you'll know which platforms fit your stock level and style, and where to start selling this week.

You don't need five sales channels on day one. You need one that matches how much inventory you have and how much time you can spend on customer messages.

Step by step

- 1 Start with Etsy if you want searchable, ongoing sales.** Etsy buyers are actively searching for handmade goods, which means your listing can sell while you sleep — but you're competing with thousands of other sellers, so photos and keywords matter more than anywhere else.
- 2 Add a Facebook Marketplace listing for local, no-shipping sales.** This works best for heavier pieces (trays, coasters sets, small river tables) where a local buyer can pick up in person and you skip packaging and shipping costs entirely.
- 3 Use Instagram as your shop window, not your only shop.** Post process videos and finished pieces, then link out to your Etsy listing or a simple "DM to order" caption on the post itself — Instagram is best at building an audience that later buys elsewhere.
- 4 Try one craft fair or maker's market before committing to a season.** A single weekend market tells you more about which pieces sell at a glance than a month of online guessing, and lets you test prices face to face.

Do this

Pick ONE primary channel for your first 10 sales. Splitting attention across four platforms before you have a repeatable listing that sells is the most common reason new sellers stall out.

CHANNEL	BEST FOR	TRADE-OFF
Etsy	Jewelry, coasters, small decor — searchable items	Listing fees + transaction fees per sale

CHANNEL	BEST FOR	TRADE-OFF
Facebook Marketplace	Large or heavy pieces, local pickup	No built-in payment protection; meet in safe public spots
Instagram Shop	Building a following, one-of-a-kind pieces	Slower to convert strangers into buyers
Craft fairs	Testing new designs, cash sales, instant feedback	Costs a table fee and a weekend of your time

Checklist

- ☐ Picked one primary channel to launch on first
- ☐ Checked that channel's selling fees before pricing anything
- ☐ Set up a seller account (or confirmed your existing one is active)

SECTION 2

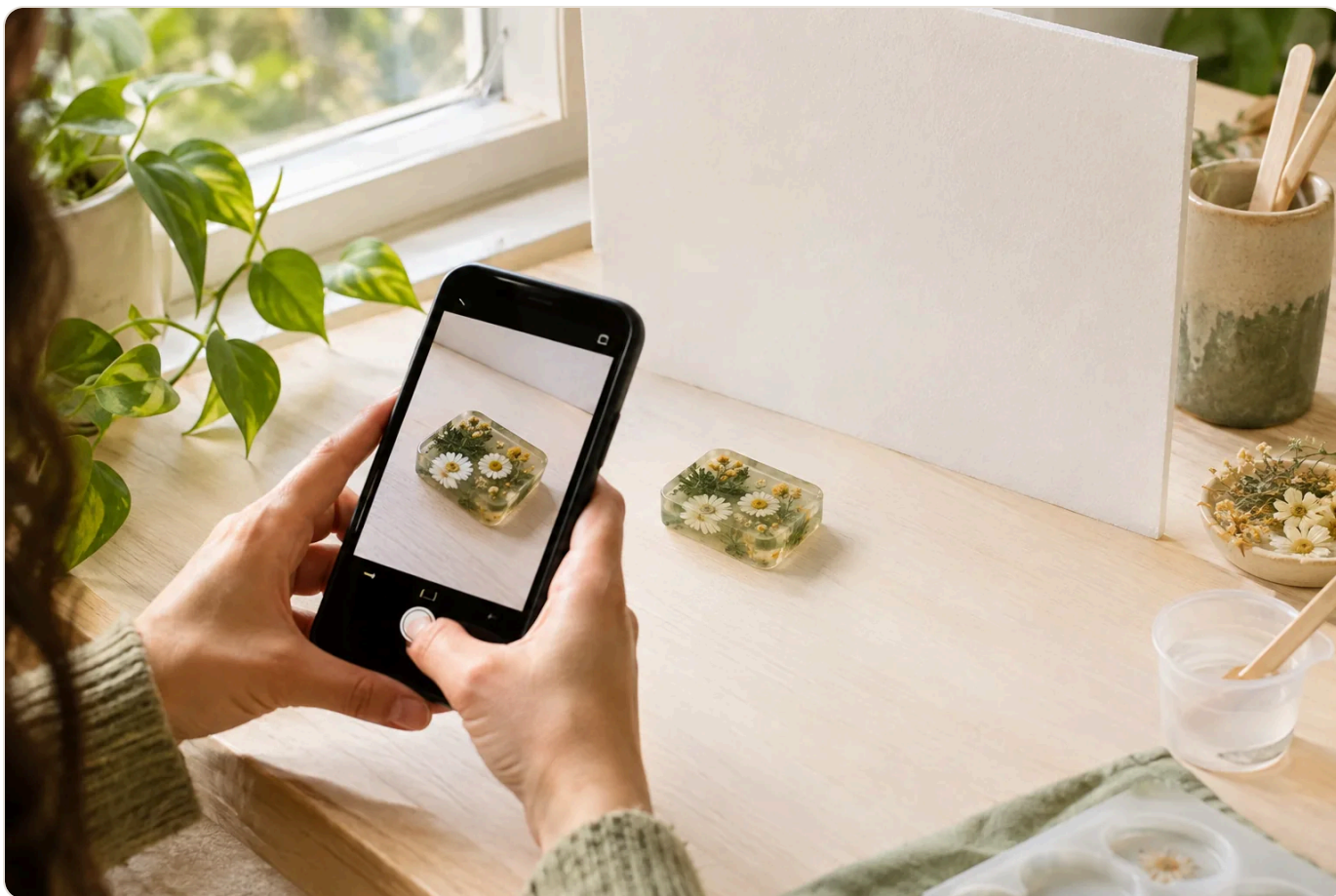
Product Photos That Sell

By the end of this section you'll be able to shoot clean, accurate product photos with a phone and things you already own.

Resin pieces live or die on their photos because buyers can't touch them or see them catch the light in person. You don't need a studio — you need consistent, bright, honest light.

Step by step

- 1 Shoot near a window, never under a ceiling light.** Indirect daylight (a bright window with no direct sun hitting the piece) gives the truest color and avoids the orange or blue cast of indoor bulbs.
- 2 Build a simple backdrop.** A piece of white foam board or poster board curved behind the piece (a "sweep") removes distracting backgrounds for under \$10.
- 3 Shoot straight-on, then at a slight angle, then a close-up of texture or sparkle.** Buyers want to see the whole piece, how it would sit on a shelf or hand, and the detail that makes resin special — the depth, the inclusions, the shine.
- 4 Include one photo with a size reference.** A coin, a ruler, or the piece worn on a hand or wrist stops the single most common return reason: "I thought it would be bigger."
- 5 Edit lightly, not heavily.** Nudge brightness and contrast in your phone's built-in editor; never shift the color so far that the piece arrives looking different than it photographed.



Common mistake

Editing colors to look more saturated than the real piece. It drives clicks but drives returns and bad reviews just as fast — accurate photos earn repeat buyers.

Checklist

- ☐ Have at least 5 photos per listing: straight-on, angled, detail/macro, scale reference, in-use or styled
- ☐ All photos shot in daylight near a window
- ☐ No edits that change the actual color of the resin or pigment

SECTION 3

Writing a Listing That Converts

By the end of this section you'll be able to write a title, description, and tags that get your piece found and chosen.

A listing has one job before the sale: answer every question a buyer would otherwise have to message you about.

Step by step

- 1 **Write a title with the item, material, and look — in that order.** Example: "Ocean Wave Resin Coasters, Set of 4, Blue & White Geode Style" tells a search engine and a human exactly what it is in one line.
- 2 **Open the description with the one-sentence hook, then the facts.** Lead with what makes the piece special, then list: exact dimensions in inches (with cm alongside), weight, colors used, and what's included in the sale.
- 3 **Answer care and durability up front.** State how to clean the piece (soft cloth, mild soap, no harsh chemicals or abrasive pads) and whether it's for display or functional use — this heads off most pre-sale questions.
- 4 **List 10-13 relevant tags/keywords if your platform supports them.** Mix broad terms ("resin coasters") with specific ones ("ocean wave coaster set") to show up in both wide and narrow searches.
- 5 **End with a clear next action.** "Add to cart" or "message me for a custom color" — never leave the buyer wondering what to do next.

Do this

Mention exact measurements in both inches and centimeters. International buyers abandon listings that only give one unit, and it's one extra line that removes a reason not to buy.

Checklist

- ☐ Title includes item type, material, and visual style
- ☐ Description states exact size (in/cm), weight, and what's included
- ☐ Care instructions are listed in the description, not just in a card you ship separately
- ☐ Tags/keywords filled in completely on the platform

SECTION 4

Pricing Your Pieces

By the end of this section you'll have a repeatable way to price any new piece without guessing.

Price by adding up your real costs first, then checking what similar, finished pieces are actually listed for — never the other way around.

Step by step

- 1 Add up your materials cost per piece.** Resin, pigment, mold wear, findings or hardware, packaging — get a real per-piece number, even if it's rough.
- 2 Add your time at an hourly rate you choose.** Count mixing, pouring, cure/wait time you spend prepping other pieces, sanding, and finishing — pick an hourly rate that feels fair to you, since this varies enormously by experience and region.
- 3 Add platform fees.** Listing fees, transaction fees, and payment processing fees typically run several percent of the sale price — check your specific platform's current fee schedule before setting a price.
- 4 Check 5-10 similar, finished listings for a reality check.** Search your exact style and size on the platform you're using and note the range other sellers are actually charging — not what you wish the market would pay.
- 5 Set your price at cost-plus-margin, adjusted to fit inside that realistic range.** If your cost-plus number is far outside what similar pieces sell for, that's a sign to either simplify the piece or reposition it as a premium, limited item.

CATEGORY OF PIECE	TYPICAL MATERIALS COST	ETSY RANGE SEEN FOR SIMILAR FINISHED PIECES*
Small jewelry (earrings, pendant)	\$1-\$4	\$12-\$30
Coaster set of 4	\$6-\$12	\$20-\$45
Serving tray or large decor piece	\$10-\$25	\$35-\$90

*Estimated ranges for similar handmade pieces as a planning reference, not a guarantee of what any specific piece will sell for. Always check current, live listings in your style before pricing.

Common mistake

Pricing only off what you'd like to earn, with no cost or market check. A price nobody will pay doesn't earn you anything — pricing is a loop you revisit every few pieces, not a one-time decision.

SECTION 5

Shipping and Return Policies

By the end of this section you'll have a written shipping and return policy ready to paste into any listing.

Resin pieces are rigid and can crack or chip in transit if they're packed loosely. A clear return policy, paired with careful packing, prevents most disputes before they start.

Step by step

- 1 Wrap each piece individually.** Bubble wrap or a padded mailer around every item, even inside a multi-item order — pieces that touch each other in transit are the top cause of shipping damage.
- 2 Use a rigid outer box for anything larger than jewelry.** A corrugated box with 1-2 inches of cushioning (packing paper, air pillows, or crumpled kraft paper) on every side keeps flat items like coasters and trays from flexing and cracking.
- 3 Write a plain shipping policy and post it on every listing.** State processing time (how many business days before you ship), shipping method, and whether you ship internationally — set expectations before the sale, not after a complaint.
- 4 Write a plain return policy.** A simple, fair policy (for example: returns accepted within 14 days for an unused, undamaged item, buyer covers return shipping) protects you more than having no policy, because platforms often default to buyer-favorable rules when there's no stated policy at all.
- 5 Photograph every package before you seal it.** One photo of the wrapped item in its box, before sealing, is your proof of condition if a damage claim ever comes up.

Checklist

- ☐ Every item individually wrapped before boxing
- ☐ At least 1-2 inches of cushioning on all sides inside the outer box
- ☐ Written shipping policy (processing time + method) posted on the listing
- ☐ Written return policy posted on the listing
- ☐ Photo taken of the packed item before sealing the box

Next Step

Now that you know how to list and ship a piece, it's time to make it look like it belongs to a real brand. Open **Brand & Packaging Blueprint** next and build the look that makes buyers trust what they're receiving before it even arrives.